

When you have received an assessment of your qualification

How to understand and use the assessment report and where to go for guidance on education, training and employment.

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Danish Agency for Higher
Education and Science
Assessment and Recognition of
Qualifications

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How to use the assessment report

You can use the assessment in Denmark: when applying for a job, for admission to a study programme or for membership of an unemployment fund.

Further study or training

When applying for admission you can include a copy of the assessment report to help the admissions officers understand your qualifications. It is always up to the individual educational institution to decide whether you are eligible for admission to a specific programme. However, the level of education indicated by the assessment is binding on the educational institution when it decides whether you satisfy the general entry requirements.

Specific admission requirements may apply to the study programme in question. In higher education, there are often requirements concerning grades obtained and subjects studied in your previous education. The educational institution decides whether you fulfil the specific requirements.

If you hold a degree equivalent to a Danish Master's degree, you can only enter a degree programme if there are vacant study places. This rule does not apply to adult education programmes and programmes under the Ministry of Culture.

The application deadline for most higher education programmes, for students with foreign qualifications, is 15 March, 12:00 noon. If you apply for a Master's de-

gree programme, you can find the application deadline and procedure on the university's website. If you apply for a programme in English and need a residence permit to study in Denmark, you should ask the institution about the deadline.

Employment

You can include a copy of the assessment report with your job application to help the employer understand your qualifications. It is, however, always up to the employer to assess whether your qualifications match the job. If they are not recent, your chances will largely depend on your professional experience.

Public employers must abide by the level of education stated in the Agency's assessment, while respecting the regulations and collective agreements in force. As a graduate being appointed to a position in the state, regional or municipal administration, your pay grading must comply with the assessment if it compares your qualification to one of the Danish degrees listed in the collective agreement.

Unemployment fund membership

If you apply for admission to an unemployment fund where a certain qualification level is required, you can enclose a copy of the assessment. The assessment does not in itself entitle you to membership, as you must also fulfil other requirements. However, if the unemployment fund requires a specific level of education, it must abide by the level of education specified in the assessment.

Where to go for guidance

Where do I get guidance on finding a job?

If you would like to get individual guidance on career options and job hunting, you should contact a job centre. The assessment may be helpful when you talk to the job centre. Find the nearest job centre: jobnet.dk.

Where do I get guidance on continuing my education?

Please visit the Education Guide at ug.dk. For programmes in English, go to studyindenmark.dk.

You can get education and career guidance at a regional guidance centre: studievalg.dk or online at eVejledning: ug.dk/evejledning.

Do I need supplementary courses?

Read about the entry requirements on ug.dk and on the websites of the educational institutions. You can ask the institution if you need supplementary courses.

Can I transfer credit?

If you enrol on a Danish programme of education and you have already studied in the same field abroad, you can apply to the educational institution for credit transfer (*merit*) in order to be exempted from parts of the Danish programme. The educational institution decides whether you are entitled to credit transfer.

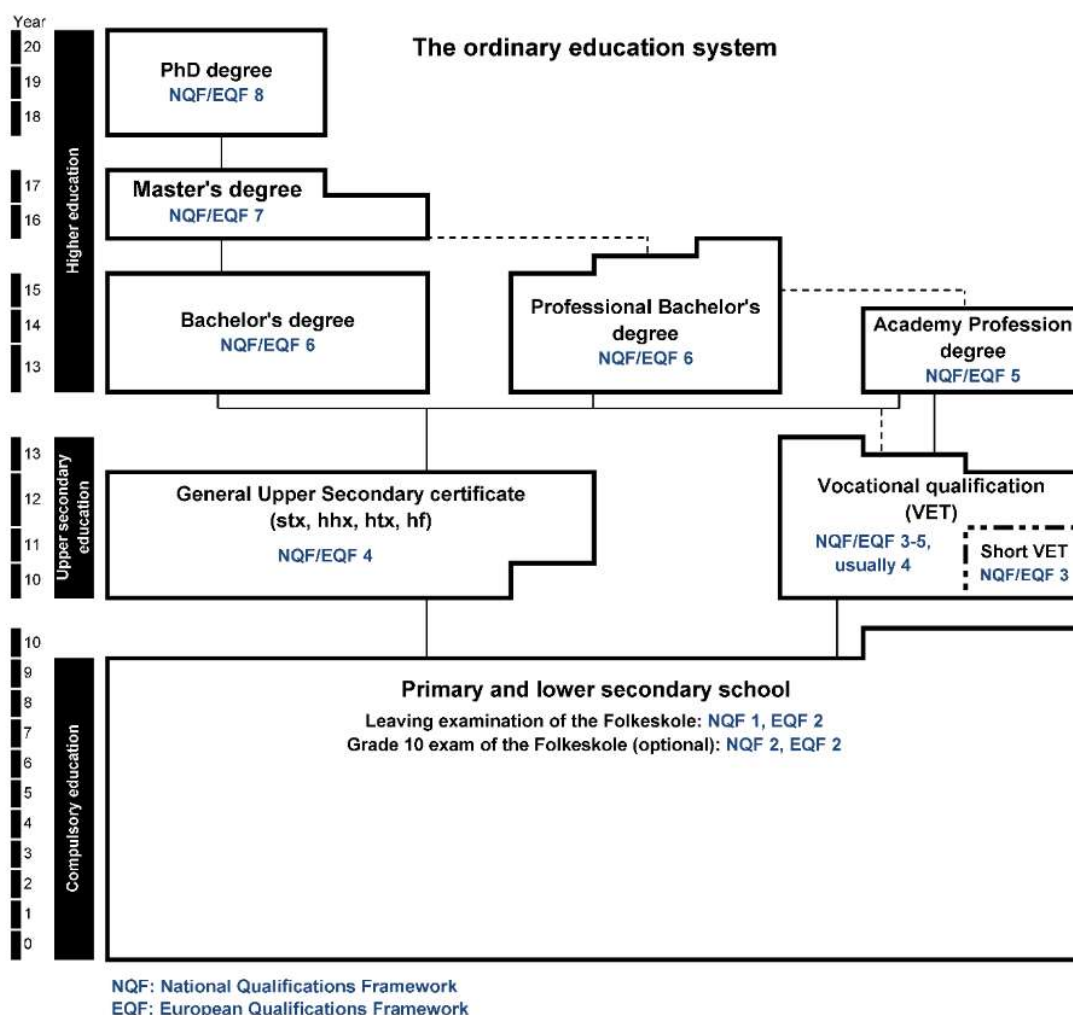
How to read the assessment report

The assessment report contains the following information:

Issued by:	The educational institution or authority that has issued the qualification certificate. We have verified that the issuing body is recognised by a competent authority.
Nominal length:	The official duration of the programme of education.
Year of completion:	The calendar year when you completed your qualification.
Access requirement:	The qualification that was required before you could study for the qualification assessed.
Assessment:	The level and, if possible, the field of education.

Level of education

The assessment indicates the level to which the qualification assessed corresponds within the Danish education system.



There are adult education qualifications at levels corresponding to those of the ordinary education system. The table shows the levels within higher education:

Adult education	Ordinary education system
Master degree (Mastergrad)	Master's degree (MA/MSc)
Diploma degree (Diplom)	Bachelor's degree Professional Bachelor's degree
Academy Profession degree (<i>Akademiuddannelse</i>)	Academy Profession degree (<i>Erhvervsakademiuddannelse</i>)

If the level of the qualification is between two levels of the Danish education system, the assessment normally indicates a number of years of a Danish programme.

Level in the qualifications framework

In the diagram on page 3 you can see the levels of qualifications within the Danish and European qualifications frameworks:

- The Danish Qualifications Framework for Lifelong Learning (NQF) covers all publicly recognised qualifications in the Danish education system.
- The European Qualifications Framework (EQF) can be used to compare and recognise qualifications across European countries.

You can find out more at nqf.dk.

Brief description of Danish education levels

Primary and lower secondary school

Leaving examination of the Folkeskole

Compulsory education lasts 10 years (grades 0 to 9) with an optional grade 10. The leaving examination consists of six compulsory exams, which pupils sit in Years 8 and 9.

Upper secondary qualification

Upper secondary qualifications include general upper secondary qualifications and vocational qualifications.

General upper secondary qualification

The general upper secondary programmes are academically oriented and theoretically based.

There are four main qualifications:

- Higher General Examination (stx, 3 years)
- Higher Technical Examination (htx, 3 years)
- Higher Commercial Examination (hhx, 3 years)
- Higher Preparatory Examination (hf, 2 years)

These programmes can be taken after passing the leaving examination of the Folkeskole, provided certain conditions are met.

Stx, htx and hhx give access to higher education. Hf including additional courses also gives access to higher education.

Hf without additional courses gives access to Academy Profession programmes and Professional Bachelor's programmes, but need supplementary courses to qualify for university Bachelor's programmes.

Vocational qualification

Vocational qualifications are obtained through vocational education and training (VET). The VET programmes prepare learners for work in specific trades and crafts. They alternate between school-based teaching and internship in a public or private enterprise.

These programmes can be taken after passing the leaving examination of the Folkeskole, provided certain conditions are met.

They vary in length, and some can be completed at various stages. Vocational qualifications based on VET programmes of at least 3 years provide access to academy profession programmes.

The assessment "a vocational qualification" indicates a level corresponding to a Danish VET qualification of 3 years or more. The assessment "a short vocational qualification" indicates a level corresponding to a Danish VET qualification of less than 3 years.

Higher education qualifications

Academy profession degree

Academy Profession (AP) programmes are higher education programmes combining theoretical knowledge with practical challenges. They require a general upper secondary qualification or a vocational qualification of at least 3 years.

Most AP programmes take 2 years to complete (120 ECTS). They prepare students for occupational functions within their field of study. In some fields, they give access to a 1½-year professional bachelor's top-up programme.

Professional bachelor's degree

The Professional Bachelor's programmes combine theoretical studies with a practically oriented approach and normally take 3 to 4 years (180-240 ECTS). They include work placements totalling six months in duration.

These programmes prepare students for practice-based, complex, and development-oriented job functions within their field of study. On certain conditions, professional bachelors can enter a Master's programme (MA/MSc).

Bachelor's degree

Bachelor's programmes are research-based programmes offered by universities. The programmes take 3 years to complete (180 ECTS).

The programmes prepare students for occupational functions and for further studies. The Bachelor's degree qualifies students for admission to a Master's programme (MA/MSc).

Master's degree (MA/MSc)

Master's programmes are research-based programmes offered by universities and building on a relevant Bachelor's degree. With a few exceptions, the programmes consist of 75 or 120 ECTS credits.

The Master's degree qualifies students for a professional career and gives access to PhD studies.

PhD degree

The PhD degree is normally awarded after three years of higher education and research (180 ECTS) following a Master's degree (MA/Msc).

Adult and continuing education

The Agency's assessments may involve comparisons with adult/continuing higher education qualifications:

Academy Profession degree (adult/continuing higher education)

Within adult/continuing higher education, Academy Profession programmes (Danish: *akademiuddannelser*) consist of 60 ECTS credits, combining theoretical studies with a practical approach.

Access requires general upper secondary education or a relevant vocational qualification. In addition, you must have at least 2 years of relevant work experience.

The programmes give access to Diploma programmes.

Diploma degree (adult/continuing higher education)

Diploma programmes (Danish: *diplomuddannelser*) consist of 60 ECTS credits, combining theoretical studies with a practical approach.

Access requires a relevant educational qualification at Academy Profession level or higher and at least 2 years of relevant work experience.

The programmes give access to relevant master programmes (adult/continuing higher education).

Master degree (adult/continuing higher education)

Master programmes (Danish: *masteruddannelser*) are research-based programmes offered by universities. They consist of 60 ECTS credits (in certain cases 90 ECTS credits).

Entry requirements are a relevant educational qualification at bachelor's level or higher and at least 2 years of relevant work experience.

Field of education

As far as possible, the assessment also indicates the field of education to which your qualification belongs in the Danish education system. If possible, the foreign qualification is compared to a specific Danish qualification. If no corresponding Danish qualification exists, the assessment normally mentions a broader field of study.

What is the assessment based on?

The assessment only includes qualifications gained through formal education and training, not competencies acquired through professional experience, short courses, non-formal education or life experience.

As far as possible, the assessment focuses on the learning outcomes of the education. The Agency makes a comparison between the foreign qualification and Danish qualifications taking into account, in particular, the following elements:

- Access requirements of the education programme: Do the access requirements of the programme that you completed match the access requirements of a corresponding Danish programme?
- Nominal length of the programme: Is the length of the programme comparable to that of a similar Danish programme?
- Aims of the programme.
- Subject combination and structure of the programme: How does the subject combination compare to that of a similar Danish programme? Does it include subjects that are not related to the main field of study? Does the programme include an independent project or thesis work? If so, what is the time allotted to this part of the programme? Is the programme research-based or not?
- The ratio of theory to practice within the programme.

The assessment is based on the information available to Agency at the time of assessment. If the Agency later receives new information about the qualification assessed, it may affect any future assessments of the same qualification.

Legal basis

The Danish Agency for Higher Education and Science provides its assessments under the Assessment of Foreign Qualifications Act (Consolidation Act no. 579 of 1 June 2014). You can find the relevant legal texts and other background information at ufsn.dk/recognition.

Complaints procedures

You cannot appeal to any other administrative authority against the content of the Agency's assessment. This is laid down in section 7 (2) of the Act. If you contact the Agency, it will deal with your query and may choose to conduct a new assessment, e.g. if you have new information changing the basis for the assessment.

About the Agency

The Danish Agency for Higher Education and Science is a part of the Ministry of Higher Education and Science. Before its establishment in October 2020, qualification assessments had been performed by the Danish Agency for Science and Higher Education, the Danish Agency for Higher Education, the Danish Agency for Universities and Internationalisation, the Danish Agency for International Education/CIRIUS and the Danish Centre for Assessment of Foreign Qualifications.